



IDS11074

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Thursday 23 July 2026
for the period until midnight CST Sunday 26 July 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A ridge of pressure system will build over South Australia this evening, with the associated high centre expected to lie over the Bight on Friday and Saturday. The high will move north over South Australia during Sunday, with a trough to build over the west of the State later Sunday ahead of a cold front to move over the Bight late Monday.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 23 July until midnight

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable below 10 knots in the early morning then becoming west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 25 July

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 26 July

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 23 July until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 25 July

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 26 July

Winds: West to northwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 23 July until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre later in the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly in the middle of the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres by early evening. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 25 July

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly 10 to 15 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 26 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning northwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 23 July until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to around 1 metre around midday. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 25 July

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 26 July

Winds: Northwest to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending northwesterly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.